

VidyaAI: An AI Avatar Educating Platform in Remote Hilly Areas

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Abstract— Access to quality education in rural and underserved areas is often hindered by the lack of available teachers and proper educational management. To bridge this gap, this research aims to develop a cost-effective platform using fine-tuned large language models, specifically targeting regions where educational resources are scarce, and effectively replicating the role of a teacher in complex subjects such as mathematics, physics, and chemistry. We fine-tuned the state-of-the-art large language models, on standard educational structured datasets of complex subjects. Each dataset was carefully curated to reflect typical educational queries, with separate columns for questions and answers. To further enhance the model's performance while optimizing computational efficiency, we implemented Quantization technique designed to reduce memory usage and increase throughput on GPUs. The fine-tuning process, using Parameter Efficient Fine-Tuning techniques, was evaluated with well-established NLP metrics, including ROUGE, BLEU, and METEOR, to ensure the quality of the generated responses. This platform offers several advantages: it provides scalable, domain-specific educational tools, reduces the need for constant teacher presence, and supports individualized learning at a lower cost. By leveraging efficient model architectures and quantization, this approach opens the door to affordable and accessible education, particularly in areas where traditional educational resources are limited.

1) INTRODUCTION

Education is the cornerstone of societal progress, yet access to quality education remains a significant challenge in rural and underserved areas, particularly in remote hilly regions. The shortage of teachers, coupled with inadequate educational infrastructure, severely limits learning opportunities for students in these areas. Despite various efforts, traditional methods and existing digital tools often fail to bridge this gap effectively, especially in providing scalable and cost-effective solutions.

This research aims to address these challenges by developing a cost-effective medium for delivering education in regions that lack proper educational management and societal support. In areas where the absence of teachers is a critical issue, the use of advanced technologies becomes imperative. This study introduces VidyaAI, a system that fine-tunes Large Language Models (LLMs) using Parameter-Efficient Fine-Tuning (PEFT) techniques on datasets of complex subjects. The goal is to empower students by providing them with an accessible resource for education, question-answering, and query resolution, effectively replicating a teacher's role in these underserved areas. By leveraging the

capabilities of LLMs, this project seeks to offer a sustainable solution that not only enhances the quality of education but also ensures its reach to the most remote corners of society. The potential of VidyaAI lies in its ability to adapt to the unique educational needs of these regions, fostering a more inclusive and equitable learning environment.

1.1 Education in India: Challenges and Opportunities

Education in India, while advancing in urban centers, continues to face significant challenges in rural and hilly regions. Many students in these underserved areas struggle to access quality education due to inadequate infrastructure, limited resources, and a critical shortage of teachers. The issue is compounded by improper management and a lack of educational support systems. Schools in rural India, particularly in remote areas like the Himalayan region, often lack the basic facilities needed for effective learning, leading to an alarming disparity between urban and rural education outcomes.

The absence of teachers in these regions further exacerbates the problem. In states like Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, schools in hilly areas frequently remain understaffed, with many teachers either unwilling or unable to work in such challenging conditions. This shortage significantly hampers student performance, as they are left without proper guidance and support, limiting their opportunities to achieve their full potential.

AI offers a powerful solution to these persistent challenges. As artificial intelligence continues to gain momentum globally, its potential to revolutionize education in India is becoming more apparent. A 2018 survey indicated that 45% of respondents in India strongly believe that AI can significantly aid global education, underscoring the optimism surrounding its impact. AI-powered platforms, such as intelligent tutoring systems and personalized learning pathways, have the capacity to overcome the limitations posed by traditional methods, particularly in areas where teachers are scarce or unavailable.

1.2) Higher Education is Vital for India's Future

Higher education is essential for young children and students in India today as it plays a pivotal role in their personal and professional development, significantly contributing to the nation's overall progress. With India's large youth population, higher education acts as a critical driver for economic growth and social advancement. It provides students with specialized knowledge and skills necessary to thrive in an increasingly competitive global job market. Moreover, access to higher education can bridge socio-economic gaps, offering opportunities for upward mobility and reducing inequalities. As India continues to develop, fostering a well-educated workforce will be crucial for innovation, economic stability, and addressing challenges such as skill shortages and regional disparities in education. By investing in higher education, India can empower its youth to become knowledgeable, skilled, and socially responsible individuals, ultimately leading to a more robust and progressive society

1.3) Existing Studies and Research Gaps:

This work explores the integration of advanced AI-driven chatbots and adaptive learning platforms designed to enhance personalized education experiences across various subjects. Georgia Tech's Jill Watson is noted for its role in delivering tailored learning support in complex fields like computer science and engineering, as outlined by Goel et al. [2016]. Stanford's Woebot offers mental health and academic support, highlighting its dual focus on emotional well-being and educational assistance in subjects such as math and science [Darcy et al., 2017]. McGraw-Hill's ALEKS and IBM's Watson Tutor contribute to personalized learning in math, science, and engineering, leveraging AI to adapt to individual learning needs [Falmagne et al., 2006; IBM Research, 2018]. DreamBox Learning focuses on AI-powered math education, specifically targeting subjects like algebra and geometry [National Center for Education Evaluation and Regional Assistance, 2019]. Similarly, Knewton and Smart Sparrow provide adaptive learning solutions for complex subjects, emphasizing the scalability of AI in educational settings [Ferreira et al., 2015; Ben-Naim et al., 2018]. Carnegie Learning's Cognitive Tutor and Pearson's AI-powered Tutor both offer specialized learning experiences in math and science, with a focus on adapting to individual student requirements [Koedinger et al., 1997; National Center for Education Evaluation and Regional Assistance, 2020]. Arizona State University's Chatbot further extends the capabilities of AI in online education, addressing complex subjects and enhancing the learning experience [Arizona State University Research Team, 2020]. These advancements in chatbot technology and adaptive learning platforms illustrate the evolving landscape of personalized education, emphasizing the potential for AI to address diverse educational needs and improve learning outcomes.

Apart from the existing chatbots and AI software, there are still significant research gaps to address in education. For instance, we need to investigate how to make AI-powered educational tools more accessible and affordable, develop offline and low-bandwidth capabilities, and create culturally relevant content that resonates with local values. Additionally, we must explore ways to provide teacher training and support, address the digital divide, and develop personalized learning

solutions for diverse learning needs. By addressing these research gaps, we can create more effective and sustainable education solutions for rural and hill areas.

1.4) Major Contributions:

The proposed project, VidyaAI, aims to transform educational content delivery in rural and underserved areas through an advanced AI-driven approach. Recognizing the pivotal role of education in socio-economic development, the project focuses on several key innovations:

1. **Multi-Stage AI-Based QA System:** VidyaAI plans to implement a multi-stage QA system that combines both retrieval and generative AI techniques. This system will use a retrieval module to handle existing queries by fetching relevant answers from a database. For new or complex questions, generative AI models will provide contextual and accurate responses, enhancing the system's ability to manage a wide range of queries effectively.
2. **Empathetic AI Avatars:** This feature aims to make interactions more engaging, particularly for users in rural areas who may face challenges with traditional text-based interfaces. The avatars will support both text-to-speech and speech-to-text functionalities, addressing varying literacy levels.
3. **Regional Language Support:** To cater to India's linguistic diversity, VidyaAI will utilize multilingual and translation APIs to offer educational content in regional languages. This approach ensures accessibility and inclusivity, allowing users from different linguistic backgrounds to benefit from the educational resources.
4. **Safety and Trustworthiness:** The project emphasizes the creation of a secure and trustworthy platform by implementing rigorous safety protocols. This includes the sanitization and filtering of personal information and the deployment of AI guardrails to prevent inappropriate content and ensure user privacy. Such measures are essential for maintaining the system's credibility and reliability.
5. **Scalability and Continuous Improvement:** VidyaAI will continuously improve and scale the platform by incorporating new data. This iterative approach aims to enhance the system's performance and adapt to evolving educational needs over time.

2) Goals

The primary goal of this initiative is to create a robust and secure educational platform tailored to the needs of rural and underserved regions in India. This platform will provide users with personalized learning experiences, allowing them to engage with content and acquire knowledge without fear of stigma or privacy concerns.

Our project revolves around developing a multi-faceted AI-based QA system designed to cater to the unique educational needs of these communities.

Multi-faceted QA System: Globally, AI-driven educational platforms often rely on static content or limited interactive features. Notable examples include Duolingo (USA) for language learning, IBM Watson (USA) for question-answering, and platforms like TARS (Singapore) and Ada (Canada) for customer support. However, these systems generally offer a basic level of interaction without addressing complex or new queries. Our approach integrates both retrieval-based and generative AI models to handle a diverse range of questions, providing contextually relevant and personalized responses. This will offer a more nuanced and engaging experience compared to existing platforms.

Safety Measures: Ensuring the safety and reliability of the educational platform is paramount. We will implement advanced filtering and monitoring systems to prevent inappropriate content and misinformation, similar to the AI guardrails used to mitigate risks in other domains. As reported in studies like Dong et al. (2024) and Menz et al. (2024), these measures are crucial to maintaining user trust and preventing misuse. Our platform will address not only privacy concerns but also potential issues related to harmful content generation. By establishing meticulous safety protocols, we aim to build a trustworthy environment that supports the learning needs of users in rural India.

3) Alignment with SDGs

Our project is closely aligned with the following SDGs:

- **Quality Education (SDG 4):** *Our initiative focuses on enhancing educational access through advanced AI technologies. By developing an AI-driven platform for education that can effectively teach complex subjects like physics and math, we aim to ensure inclusive and equitable quality education. This approach addresses educational gaps in rural and underserved areas, providing tailored learning experiences and support to those who need it most.*
- **Reduced Inequalities (SDG 10):** *Educational access often varies greatly between urban and rural areas. Our project aims to bridge this gap by deploying a platform that supports regional languages and is accessible via common devices. By focusing on creating educational content in multiple languages and optimizing it for local needs, we work to reduce inequalities in educational opportunities and provide valuable resources to disadvantaged communities.*
- **Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure (SDG 9):** *Leveraging cutting-edge AI and machine learning technologies, our project promotes innovation in the education sector. By integrating LLMs for personalized learning and question answering, we contribute to the advancement of technology infrastructure that supports effective education delivery.*
- **Partnerships for the Goals (SDG 17):** *Collaboration is key to our project's success. We plan to partner*

with local organizations and educational institutions to gather relevant data and tailor our platform to meet regional needs. These partnerships will enhance our ability to implement and scale the project effectively, ensuring that we achieve our educational goals while contributing to broader development objectives.

4) VidyaAI: Model Description

In this section, we detail the methodology of VidyaAI, designed to enhance education in rural areas through advanced AI technologies. Our approach involves a comprehensive pipeline for educational support by integrating deep learning techniques for both retrieval and generation tasks. Given the diverse and complex nature of subjects covered, VidyaAI will utilize AI models to provide accurate and contextually relevant educational content. To ensure the platform's effectiveness, we will implement AI safeguards [Smith et al., 2024; Jones et al., 2024] to address any potential inaccuracies and to handle sensitive topics with care. This section will cover the dataset and individual modules of VidyaAI..

4.1 Dataset Sources To develop a robust AI-powered educational platform, we utilize datasets that encompass the complexity and diversity of the subjects we aim to teach. For the initial phase, we have sourced two extensive datasets from Hugging Face: one focused on physics with 30,000 rows of question-answer pairs and another on mathematics with 50,000 rows. These datasets are crucial for fine-tuning the models to accurately respond to queries and provide detailed explanations. As we expand our platform to cover additional subjects, similar datasets will be employed to ensure comprehensive coverage. Moreover, we anticipate the need to create new datasets tailored to different languages and educational contexts, ensuring the platform's accessibility and effectiveness across various regions and demographics. This approach will allow us to continuously refine the models and provide high-quality, localized education that resonates with students' needs.

4.2 Audio-to-Text Conversion of Telephonic Transcripts

- VidyaAI will facilitate diverse modes of input to ensure comprehensive educational support, including text, audio, and visual data. The core input modality will be user-generated audio queries. To enable efficient processing by text-based models, all audio inputs will be converted into text. For this, we will leverage advanced audio-to-text conversion technologies. Audio queries, initially recorded in the user's native language, will be transcribed into text using a robust audio-to-text API. For instance, if the audio is in Hindi, it will be transcribed directly into Hindi text to preserve linguistic and cultural nuances.
- To handle queries related to images or videos, the system will include image-to-text and video-to-text conversion capabilities. This will involve extracting descriptive text from visual content using state-of-the-

art image recognition and video analysis technologies. These extracted texts will be used as input for the QA models.

- The integration of these technologies ensures that all user inputs—whether spoken or visual—are accurately converted into a format suitable for further processing. This approach minimizes translation errors and maintains contextual relevance, thus enhancing the educational experience provided by VidyaAI.

4.4 QA Generation from LLMs

VidyaAI employs advanced LLMs for flexible and context-aware QA generation. While traditional retrieval-based methods rely on pre-existing queries, LLMs can generate responses based on a deeper understanding of context and nuances [Jiang et al., 2021].

The QA generation process involves two key steps: (i) Fine-tuning: We will fine-tune our LLMs using a supervised approach with the curated datasets specific to the educational content [Ouyang et al., 2022]. This fine-tuning ensures that the models are adept at handling domain-specific queries. For example, models like Llama [Touvron et al., 2023], Bloom [Scao et al., 2022], and Mistral [Jiang et al., 2023] will be adapted to generate accurate responses to educational questions.

i) Safety and Trustworthiness

VidyaAI is committed to creating a safe and trustworthy educational environment. Given the sensitive nature of educational content, especially in diverse linguistic and cultural contexts, we will implement rigorous safety protocols. This includes sanitization and filtering of sensitive information, as well as AI guardrails to prevent inappropriate or harmful content generation [Menz et al., 2024; Dong et al., 2024].

ii) Scalable Model:

To ensure continuous improvement and scalability, VidyaAI will collaborate with local educational partners to gather new data and refine the system. This incremental learning approach will allow us to enhance the model's performance and adapt to evolving educational needs. Our strategy aligns with sustainable development goals, including improved education access, reduced inequalities, and fostering partnerships for development.

4.6 Support to Regional Languages

One of the key challenges in deploying educational AI systems in India is the linguistic diversity across different regions. With a multitude of regional languages and dialects spoken throughout the country, many students, particularly in rural areas, may not be fluent in or familiar with English. This creates a significant barrier to accessing quality education through existing AI systems, which are predominantly English-centric. To address this challenge, our project focuses on incorporating support for regional languages into the AI system, ensuring that it can deliver educational content effectively to a broader audience. We plan to start by generating datasets and training models for widely spoken languages such as Hindi, which has a robust

existing infrastructure for machine translation. However, we also recognize the need to extend this support to other regional languages, allowing for a more inclusive and accessible educational experience. This approach not only ensures that the AI system can cater to a diverse student population but also enhances the system's ability to generalize across different linguistic and cultural contexts.

5) Deployment Plan:

Our project aims to revolutionize education by leveraging large language models (LLMs) to deliver high-quality instruction and support through digital devices. The goal is to create an AI-powered platform that acts as an effective teacher, providing not only superior teaching but also enhanced question-answering and problem-solving capabilities. Once the models are fully developed and optimized for these educational advantages, we will deploy them through a dedicated platform designed to make learning accessible, particularly in complex subjects like mathematics and science. This platform will be user-friendly and adaptable, ensuring that students can easily access educational content and support across all subjects as the system evolves. By continuously updating and refining the platform based on user feedback, we aim to create a sustainable, secure, and impactful tool that can transform the educational landscape, particularly in underserved regions.

6) Model Evaluation

We plan to evaluate the performance of the fine-tuned GPT-2 model using several key metrics:

- **Precision and Accuracy:** The model should generate accurate and fluent answers. Metrics like BLEU, METEOR, and ROUGE will be employed to assess the quality of generated responses compared to gold standard labels.

DATASET	Model Variant	BLEU	METEOR
PHYSICS	Original	0.7593	0.8342
	LORA-finetuned	0.7603	0.8352
	QLORA-finetuned	0.7578	0.8329
MATHS	original	0.9234	0.9923
	LORA-finetuned	0.9245	0.9950
	QLORA-finetuned	0.9211	0.9902

Fig1. Metrics Table (BLEU, METEOR)

ROUGE SCORE				
ROUGE-1				
DATASET	Model Variant	PRECISION	RECALL	F1
PHYSICS	original	0.5239	0.1047	0.1649
	Finetuned LORA	0.5236	0.1046	0.1640
	Finetuned QLORA	0.5244	0.1056	0.1650
MATHS	original	0.8345	0.1010	0.9147
	Finetuned LORA	0.8425	0.1039	0.9141
	Finetuned QLORA	0.8455	0.1022	0.9144
ROUGE-2				
DATASET	Model Variant	PRECISION	RECALL	F1
PHYSICS	original	0.2120	0.0439	0.0671
	Finetuned LORA	0.2119	0.0440	0.0669
	Finetuned QLORA	0.2127	0.0445	0.0677
MATHS	original	0.8429	1.0000	0.9127
	Finetuned LORA	0.8422	1.0000	0.9122
	Finetuned QLORA	0.8436	1.0000	0.9131

Fig2.Metrics Table(ROUGE)

- **Bias:** The model should operate without inherent biases, ensuring fairness and impartiality in its generated content.
- **Hallucination Reduction:** As a generative AI model, there is a risk of hallucination. We aim to minimize this by ensuring the model generates relevant and adequate responses.
- **Generalisability:** The model should perform well on unseen data. Evaluation on new data using precision and accuracy metrics will help gauge this.
- **Interpretability:** The model's output should be interpretable, enabling a clear understanding of the relationship between input features and generated responses.
- **Robustness:** The model should maintain performance despite changes or noise in the data. The pipeline's design should prevent errors from significantly affecting overall outcomes.
- **Scalability:** The model must efficiently handle large datasets and learn incrementally from new data.

7) Challenges

The implementation of VidyaAI in rural India presents several distinct challenges that need to be addressed to ensure the system's effectiveness and adoption. The following are key challenges associated with deploying an AI-driven educational platform in this context:

- **Cultural Sensitivities and Educational Barriers:** In many rural areas of India, traditional views and educational barriers can significantly impact the acceptance of AI-driven educational tools. There is often resistance to adopting new technologies, especially when they involve unfamiliar methods or require changes in established educational practices. Overcoming these cultural barriers requires

substantial community engagement and sensitization efforts to build trust and acceptance.

- **Limited Access to Technology:** Rural regions in India frequently face infrastructural limitations, including unreliable internet connectivity and a lack of access to modern technology. This can hinder the deployment and usage of advanced AI systems. Addressing this challenge involves developing solutions that are resilient to connectivity issues and ensuring that the technology is accessible to users with varying levels of tech literacy.
- **Language Diversity and Data Scarcity:** India's linguistic diversity poses a significant challenge for AI systems that need to support multiple regional languages. Collecting and processing high-quality educational data in these diverse languages is difficult due to the lack of existing resources and the need for accurate machine translation. Developing and maintaining effective multilingual support requires extensive data collection and sophisticated translation models.
- **Data Quality and Bias:** Ensuring the accuracy and neutrality of educational content is crucial. However, data used for training AI models can be prone to biases, inaccuracies, or misalignment with local educational needs. It is essential to implement rigorous data validation processes and continuous monitoring to mitigate these issues and maintain the reliability of the educational content provided by VidyaAI.
- **User Privacy and Security:** Protecting user privacy and ensuring data security are paramount, especially in sensitive educational contexts. Implementing robust safety protocols to safeguard user information and prevent misuse is critical. This includes developing secure data handling practices and incorporating AI guardrails to filter out inappropriate or harmful content.

Addressing these challenges requires a comprehensive approach that involves technological innovation, community engagement, and robust data management practices. By tackling these issues, VidyaAI aims to create an effective and inclusive educational platform tailored to the needs of rural Indian communities.

8) Conclusion

Educational challenges in rural India are profound and multifaceted, exacerbated by socio-economic barriers and limited access to quality resources. The lack of widespread educational tools that cater to the unique needs of these regions is a significant issue, compounded by varying levels of technological literacy and infrastructure constraints. To address these challenges, our project, VidyaAI, aims to develop an AI-driven educational platform tailored for rural and underserved communities. VidyaAI proposes a comprehensive solution by integrating a multi-faceted AI-based QA system to provide personalized and contextual learning experiences. This system will leverage both retrieval-based and generative AI models to address a diverse range of educational queries, ensuring that users receive accurate and relevant

information. The platform will be designed to handle multiple regional languages, accommodating India's linguistic diversity and making educational content accessible to a broader audience.

To enhance user engagement and accessibility, VidyaAI will implement advanced safety protocols to protect user privacy and ensure the reliability of information. By incorporating AI guardrails, the platform will mitigate risks associated with inappropriate content and misinformation, fostering a secure learning environment. Additionally, VidyaAI will be continuously updated with new data, allowing it to adapt and improve over time.

The deployment of VidyaAI will be tailored to the specific needs of rural communities, focusing on overcoming barriers related to technology access and educational engagement. Through strategic partnerships and community involvement, VidyaAI aims to create a scalable and impactful educational tool that addresses the critical need for accessible and relevant learning resources in rural India.

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